

FOR PARENTS OF CHILDREN AGED 2-16

MOBILE ADDICTION IN CHILDREN

A 21-Day Plan for Parents

Child-psychology based · Comics for the whole family · Scripts, worksheets & daily trackers



21 daily steps

21 comic stories

Age-wise tips 2-16

WHO & IAP guidance



Sushma Ma'am

Child Specialist Educator & Child Psychology Expert

Mobile Addiction in Children: A 21-Day Plan for Parents

by Sushma Ma'am

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Important: This book offers educational guidance for parents based on child psychology and published public-health recommendations (WHO, Indian Academy of Pediatrics, American Academy of Pediatrics). It is not a medical diagnosis or a substitute for professional care. If your child shows signs of severe distress, self-harm, aggression, or a sudden change in behaviour, please consult a paediatrician, child psychologist or psychiatrist. In India you can call Tele-MANAS 14416 (free, 24x7).

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

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- Child Specialist Educator with years of classroom and parent-counselling experience
- Child Psychology Expert – focuses on emotions, behaviour and healthy habits
- Author of the kids' comic "LEVEL UP AI: Defeat the Glitch King"
- Believes in "connection before correction" – firm limits with warm hearts

A letter to you, dear parent

If you picked up this book, you have probably seen it: the blank stare at a screen, the tears when the phone is taken away, the 'five more minutes' that never ends. First, please know this – **you are not a bad parent, and your child is not a bad child**. Phones and apps are designed by very clever people to hold attention. Children's brains are still growing the 'brakes' that adults use to stop.

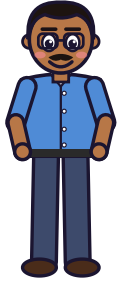
This book will not ask you to throw the phone away. It will help you, step by step over 21 days, to **understand** your child, **replace** screen time with real joy, and **build** habits your family can keep. Each day has a short comic you can read with your child, a clear action, the psychology behind it, and exactly what to say.

Go slowly, be kind to yourself, and celebrate small wins. Your connection with your child is stronger than any app.

— Sushma Ma'am

Meet the Sharma family

You will meet this family in the comic at the start of every day. Maybe you will see a little of your own home in them!



Rohit (Papa)

Works long hours; scrolls news and reels to "relax".



Neha (Mummy)

Loving, tired, sometimes hands over the phone to finish work.



Riya, 14

Social media, chats and late-night scrolling.



Aarav, 10

Loves mobile games; melts down when asked to stop.



Anaya, 6

Cartoons during every meal; cries without the phone.



Dadi

Full of stories and games – the family's secret weapon!



Sushma Ma'am

Your guide – explains the psychology and the plan.

How to use this book

1. Read **Part 1** first (about an hour). Understanding the "why" makes every step easier.
2. Do **one day at a time**. Read the comic with your child, then do the day's action together.
3. Use the "**Say this, not that**" scripts – words matter more than rules.
4. Pick the **age-wise** tips that fit your child. Skip what does not fit.
5. Tick the **21-day tracker** every night. Missed a day? Just continue – no guilt.
6. If you see a **red-flag box** sign in your child, talk to a professional (Part 3).

What the coloured boxes mean



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What Research Says



Sushma Ma'am Says



Say This, Not That



Activity



Age-wise Guide



Red Flag – Seek Help



Today's Win



One promise before you start

Change your own screen habits alongside your child's. Children copy what we do far more than what we say. This is a family plan, not a punishment for the child.

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My 21-Day Family Tracker

Every night, colour one star for each: ★ we did the action · ★ we stayed calm · ★ we had fun together. Put this page on the fridge!

Day 1 Screen detective ☆☆☆	Day 2 Family meeting ☆☆☆	Day 3 Screen-free zones ☆☆☆	Day 4 Digital sunset ☆☆☆	Day 5 Boredom jar ☆☆☆	Day 6 Parents go first ☆☆☆	Day 7 Review & celebrate ☆☆☆
Day 8 Outdoor play ☆☆☆	Day 9 Stories & books ☆☆☆	Day 10 Calm the storm ☆☆☆	Day 11 Little helpers ☆☆☆	Day 12 Creative hobbies ☆☆☆	Day 13 Good screen time ☆☆☆	Day 14 Week 2 review ☆☆☆
Day 15 Family media plan ☆☆☆	Day 16 Tweens & teens ☆☆☆	Day 17 Safe online ☆☆☆	Day 18 Self-control ☆☆☆	Day 19 Study time ☆☆☆	Day 20 Slip-ups ☆☆☆	Day 21 Celebrate! ☆☆☆
🏆 Our reward at the end of Week 1 _____			🏆 Our reward at the end of Day 21 _____			

PART 1

Understand

Why screens hook young brains, how much is too much, and how to tell if your child needs help.



CHAPTER

1

PART 1 · UNDERSTAND

Is My Child Addicted?

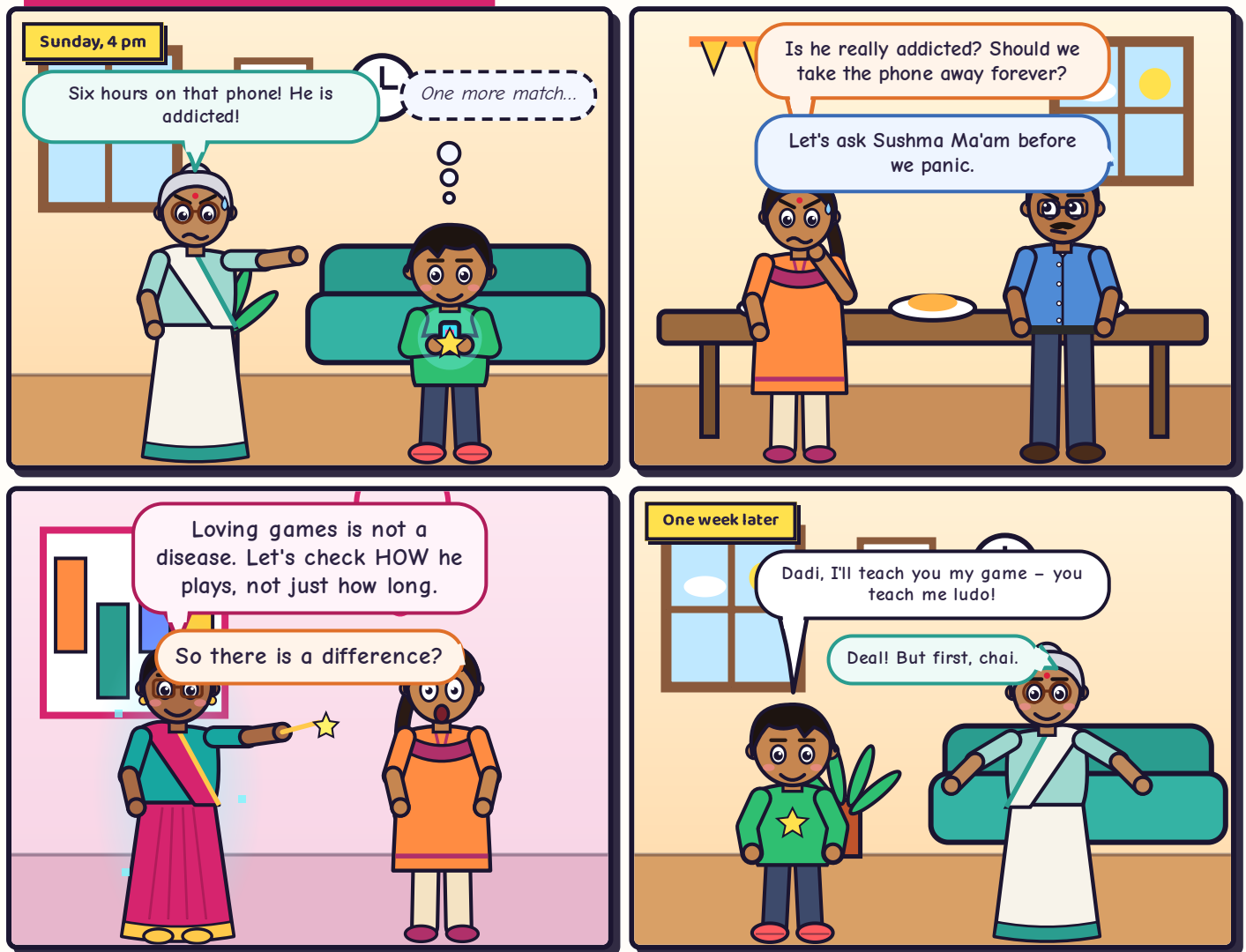
🎯 Tell healthy use, over-use and a real problem apart.

🕒 15 min read

✅ 4 C check



💬 Comic: "This Boy Is Addicted!"



💬 Sushma Ma'am says



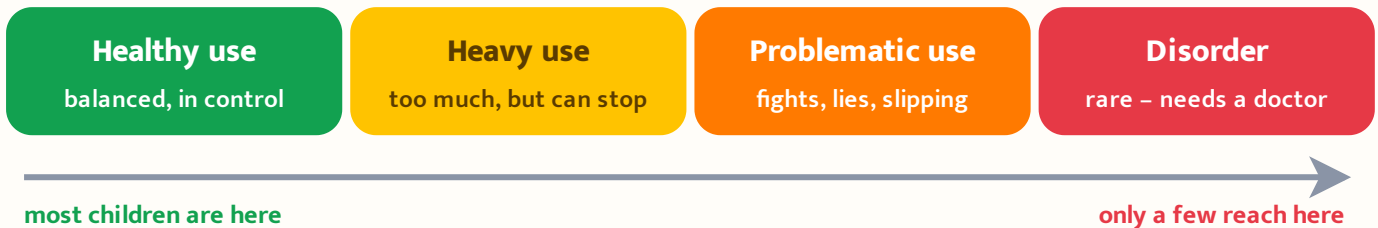
When parents come to me, the first word is often "addiction". I understand the fear. But a label can make us panic and fight. In this chapter we will look calmly at **what is normal, what is a warning sign, and what really needs a doctor** – so you can respond with a plan, not with fear.

What do people mean by "mobile addiction"?

In everyday talk, "addiction" simply means *"my child uses the phone too much and I can't stop it"*. Doctors use the word more carefully. For them, the question is not only **how many hours**, but **whether the child has lost control** and whether screen use is **damaging daily life** – sleep, studies, family, friendships, mood.

A child who watches cartoons for two hours on a holiday and then happily goes out to play is **not** addicted. A child who secretly plays till 2 a.m., skips meals, lies about it and explodes when stopped – every day, for months – needs more help. Most children are somewhere in between, and that middle zone is exactly where parents can make the biggest difference.

The screen-use spectrum



Your aim: move your child one step to the LEFT – not to zero screens.

Healthy use	Heavy / over-use	Problematic use
Stops when asked, maybe with a little grumbling	Needs many reminders; sulks	Rage, crying, hitting or begging almost every time
Sleep, homework, play are fine	Sleep and homework start slipping	Marks, sleep, friendships clearly suffering
Enjoys other things too	Other hobbies feel "boring"	Gave up sports, friends, hobbies
Open about what they watch	Some sneaking	Lies, hides devices, uses at night

Gaming disorder: what it is – and what it is not

The World Health Organization (WHO) added "**gaming disorder**" to its disease classification, **ICD-11**. This was important, because it told the world that for a small number of people, gaming can become a real health problem. But read the description carefully – it is much more than "plays a lot".

ICD-11 gaming disorder IS...

- **Impaired control** – cannot limit when, how long or how often he plays.
- **Gaming takes priority** over other interests and daily activities.
- **Continuing despite harm** – keeps going even when school, health or family clearly suffer.
- Serious impact on life, usually seen for **at least 12 months**.

It is NOT...

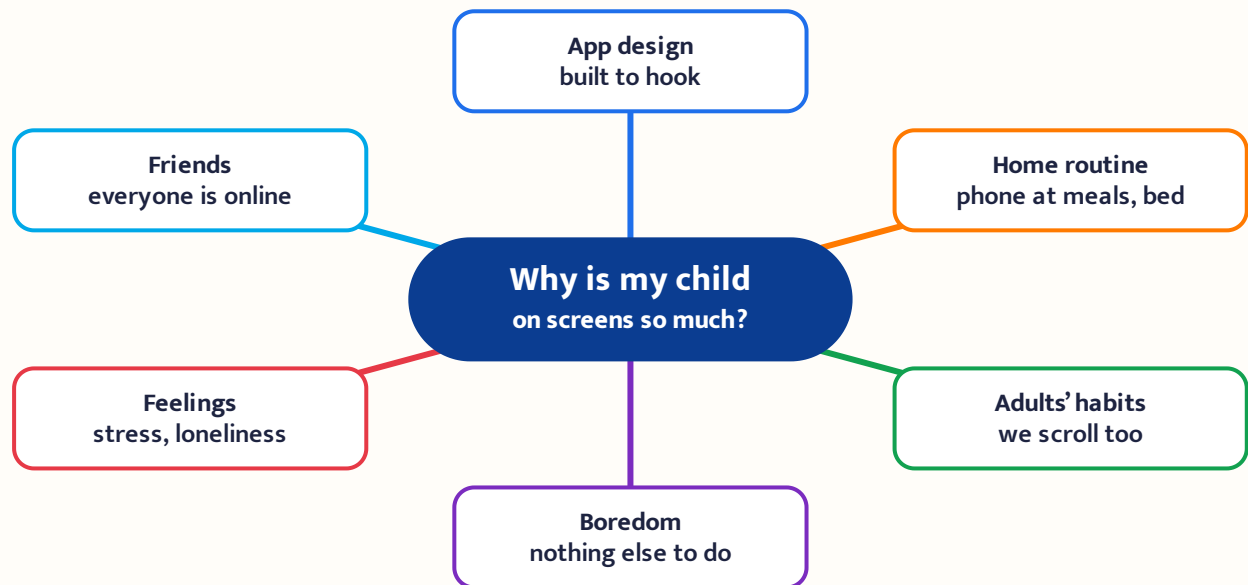
- A child who loves games and talks about them all day.
- A few weeks of heavy use during holidays.
- A diagnosis parents can make at home, or from a quiz.
- A label to shout during an argument.

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Research on gaming disorder suggests that **only a small minority** of people who play games meet these criteria. Often, very heavy screen use is a **sign of something else** – boredom, loneliness, bullying, stress about studies, anxiety, ADHD or low mood. The screen becomes an escape. That is why we always ask *"What is the screen doing for my child?"* and not only *"How do I stop it?"*

A family issue, not a "bad child" issue

Phones were designed by very clever adults to hold attention – and they hold ours too. When a child over-uses screens, it is usually a mix of **the device design, the home routine, what the adults do, and what the child is feeling**. That is good news: it means there are many places where the family can make small changes together.



Sushma Ma'am's 4 C's of healthy screen use

Counting hours is useful, but it is not enough. Over the years with families, I have used a simple check with four C's. **This is my own practical framework, not a medical test** – but it helps parents see the whole picture quickly.

Sushma Ma'am's 4 C's of healthy screen use

C1 CONTENT

What is my child watching or playing? Is it age-right?

C2 CONTEXT

When, where, how long?
Meals, bedtime, homework?

C3 CONNECTIONS

Does it connect him with people or pull him away from them?

C4 CONTROL

Can she stop calmly when time is up – without a war?

Screens are tools. You are the parent.

Firm, warm and consistent parenting beats any app. Keep the family media plan on the fridge, keep talking, and keep playing together.

More from Sushma Ma'am & VS Sir

- LEVEL UP AI: Defeat the Glitch King – comic for kids 8–14
- NEET Physics: 30-Day Rapid Revision
- Practical Guide to AI for Educators

All books: vcakota20-web.github.io/ai-mastery-with-vs-sir/books/

Parent workshops for schools: WhatsApp +91 96024 05311 · vcakota20@gmail.com

